Yun Chen

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Profile

Chief Scientist leading generative models at Viggle AI; previously a founding member of Waabi AI, working on world models for self-driving vehicles. 8 years shipping research into production.

Experience

Viggle AI *Chief Scientist* Feb. 2026 – present

- **Viggle-Remake**: open video editing (recast, add/remove objects, restyle) that keeps motion and sound. **Agent-first**: via MCP, Claude Code or Codex remakes a **2-minute music video** end to end.
- **Viggle-Turbo**: **5× faster** Qwen-Image-2.1, released two days after the base model; **#9 trending model** and **#4 trending Space** on Hugging Face.
- **Viggle-Animate**: **6× faster** than Wan2.2-Animate-14B with better quality, in three forward passes.
- **Meridian**: independent control of camera motion and scene time; Hugging Face Space of the week.

Waabi AI *Founding Member, Staff Researcher* Jun. 2021 – Nov. 2025

- Developed **Waabi World**, the generative sensor simulator used to validate Waabi's driverless launch.

Uber ATG *Research Scientist* Sep. 2018 – Feb. 2021

- Led **GeoSim**, generative video simulation for self-driving: **CVPR 2021 Best Paper Candidate**.

Education

University of Toronto, Ph.D. in Computer Science 2021 – Expected 2026
Advisor: Raquel Urtasun. Departmental thesis defense passed (2025).

Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications, M.S. and B.Eng. 2012 – 2019

Selected Publications (first or co-first author)

- Flux4D: Flow-based Unsupervised 4D Reconstruction. *NeurIPS 2025*
- G3R: Gradient Guided Generalizable Reconstruction. *ECCV 2024*
- UniSim: A Neural Closed-Loop Sensor Simulator. *CVPR 2023, Highlight*
- GeoSim: Realistic Video Simulation via Geometry-Aware Composition for Self-Driving. *CVPR 2021, **Best Paper Candidate***

Open Source (~19K GitHub stars)

- **PyTorch book**: bestselling book (**20K+ copies**); companion repo with **12K+ GitHub stars**.
- **Simple-GSPO**: minimal GSPO implementation for LLM reinforcement-learning post-training.
- **Simple-Faster-RCNN**: the first pure PyTorch implementation of Faster R-CNN.
- **MiniGo**: Go agent trained with behavior cloning, self-play and MCTS (course project, 2021).
- Early PyTorch community member, thanked by the PyTorch team for forum support (as *chenyuntc*).

Skills

- **Research**: video and image generation, world models, step distillation, quantization-aware training.
- **Systems**: distributed training (FSDP), FP8, CUDA, inference optimization, PyTorch, Linux (12+ years).